
Ayodhya Airport

implementing UDAN, which has operated 649 routes connecting 93 airports, including heliports and water aerodromes. The scheme has already served over 1.56 crore passengers. Looking ahead, more airports are expected to open under UDAN, boosting regional growth and enhancing emergency service access.

Airport Infrastructure and Passenger Experience

In FY 2024-25, the Airports Authority of India achieved significant milestones in the establishment of world-class airport infrastructure.

In the fiscal year 2025-26, the Airports Authority of India (AAI) maintained its progress with the development of new terminal buildings at Varanasi, Agra, Darbhanga, Jammu, Udaipur, Jodhpur, Bagdogra, Hisar etc. The recently commissioned passenger terminal buildings at Patna, Datia, Satna, and Tuticorin airports, along with an interim terminal building at Purnea Airport, are poised to revolutionize regional air travel, thereby broadening the network of upgraded airport infrastructure. These initiatives represent a substantial advancement in India's aviation industry, establishing a foundation for future expansion and enhanced connectivity.

AAI believes that airports are more than just transit points; they are cultural ambassadors that should proudly present India's diverse and ancient artistic traditions to the world. AAI's new airport terminals enhance the travel experience by integrating regional art and cultural elements, transforming them into immersive spaces that reflect local heritage.

Technological advancements and sustainability efforts

To further improve the travel experience, the government launched Digi Yatra in the year 2022, a paperless, contactless system using facial recognition to FastTrack and streamline passenger processing at airports. By March 2025, over 52.2 million passengers used the service, and the app has been downloaded 12.1 million times.

The Airports Authority of India's Sustainable Green Airports Mission (SUGAM), launched in 2023, promotes environmental practices across AAI-managed airports. Currently, 87 airports run entirely on green energy, advancing India's goal of net-zero emissions by 2030.

Expanding the aviation ecosystem: future outlook, new terminals/ airports maintenance and training

AAI is swiftly developing a comprehensive strategy to expand existing airports and create new ones in alignment with India's rapid aviation growth.

Passenger traffic is also projected to experience a substantial increase—expected to reach 500 Million per Annum by 2030. To accommodate this growing demand, AAI is constructing new airports and terminal buildings throughout the nation, fully equipped with modern, scalable, and efficient infrastructure.

In parallel, significant strides have been made in establishing Flying Training Organizations (FTOs) to meet the growing demand for skilled commercial pilots, aligning India's human resource development with its expanding aviation sector. Currently, 40 FTOs are operational across various states, including Bihar, Gujarat, Haryana, Jharkhand, Karnataka, Kerala, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Odisha, Punjab, Rajasthan, Tamil Nadu, Telangana, and Uttar Pradesh. These institutions offer diverse training programs, helping to shape the future of aviation in India by providing aspiring pilots and aviation professionals with essential skills.

The booming civil aviation sector is also driving the growth of the Maintenance, Repair, and Overhaul (MRO) industry in India. Although still in its early stages, the sector is expanding rapidly due to rising consumer demand, an increasing fleet size, and supportive policies. The growth of India's MRO industry is expected to reduce foreign exchange outflows, create more jobs, strengthen domestic MRO capabilities, and shorten turnaround times for airlines.

Conclusion

In line with Hon'ble Prime Minister's vision to transform India's aviation sector by 2047, driven by rapid growth, technological innovation, and sustainability with plans to expand to 350 operational airports, Airports Authority of India under the guidance of Ministry of Civil Aviation is poised to make India a Global Aviation Leader.

AAI's investments in expanding the Indian airport network, upgrading Air Navigation Systems, training & research, and sustainability initiatives like the Green Airports Mission (SUGAM) will pave the way for a future-proof aviation ecosystem, aligning with the vision of Aatmanirbhar Bharat, empowering India's self-reliance in aviation. The growth of the MRO sector will reduce dependence on foreign services and create jobs, strengthening India's self-reliance.

By 2047, India's aviation sector will not only drive economic growth and inclusivity but will also set new standards for global air travel, making it more connected, efficient, and environmentally sustainable.


Surat Airport


Tuticorin Airport



Jabalpur Airport